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Assignment Overview

Every day, AI based tools help make more decisions that affect people’s lives, from suggesting music to screening job applications to mortgage approvals. Some of these uses feel harmless. Others carry real consequences.

1. As you think about how you use generative AI, ask yourself:

1 / 1 point

Where do you draw the line between helpful and high stakes?

By being careful with critical information like medicine and law, and always checking the AI's output before acting on it.

2. Governments and organizations around the world are wrestling with the questions around how and when to use AI ethically. The European Union has begun rolling out policies to classify AI systems by risk level, while many U.S. states and companies are still writing their first guidelines. These early frameworks remind us that trust in AI is not automatic; it must be earned through transparency and accountability.

1 / 1 point

Would you trust an AI to plan your vacation, summarize research, or grade a paper? What about to review job applications or recommend medical treatments? Different answers are fine. What matters is the reasoning behind them.

Planning a vacation, summarizing research, or giving feedback on a paper are all low-stakes uses. The worst outcome is a bad restaurant recommendation or a missed point in a summary, which can be easily fixed.

Reviewing job applications or recommending medical treatments affects real people's lives in ways that are hard to reverse. An AI might screen out a great candidate based on biased patterns, or suggest a treatment without knowing your full medical history. The stakes are high and the errors aren't always obvious.

3. What would you personally trust a model to handle? Where would you still want a human in the loop? Describe a situation in your own life or field where you would draw that boundary, and explain why.

1 / 1 point

If the stakes are high and the errors aren't always obvious, human needs to stay in the loop. If I can easily spot and fix a mistake, AI is a great helper. If a mistake could hurt someone or is hard to undo, I would use AI as a starting point but never the final word.